

What Is an Overview?

An **overview** is a **high-level summary of a topic, system, project, document, or process**. Its purpose is to help someone quickly understand **what something is, why it exists, and what its major parts are** without going into all the details.

An overview might answer:

- **What is it?** - A brief description of the application, project, or topic.
- **Why does it exist?** - The business problem, need, or purpose it addresses.
- **Who uses it?** - The main users or stakeholders.
- **What does it do?** - Its primary capabilities or functions.
- **How does it work at a high level?** - The major components or overall process.
- **What benefits does it provide?** - The expected value, outcomes, or advantages.

An overview is generally **broad** and **less detailed** than a technical description.

Example: Corporate Policy AI Assistant

Detailed description:

The application sends a user's query through an API to Azure AI Search, performs vector similarity retrieval against indexed policy chunks, combines the retrieved context with the user's prompt, and sends the augmented prompt to an LLM.

Overview:

The Corporate Policy AI Assistant helps employees quickly find answers to questions about corporate policies by using AI to search organizational policy documents and generate relevant, conversational responses.

You can think of an **overview as the 'big picture' explanation** that someone should read before getting into requirements, architecture, use cases, workflows, or technical details.

Simple way to distinguish related sections

Overview = What is this project or system?

Problem Statement = What problem are we trying to solve?

Solution = How are we going to solve the problem?